**Working Draft: Writing Up My Interview (Major Project 2)**

*This section is part of my working draft. It uses quotes from my interview with Ethan Wong, an Industrial Engineering intern at Lockheed Martin, as evidence for how writing works in his workplace.*

The definition of "good" writing is always changing because it depends on who is reading and what that reader has to do next. Ethan is a junior at UCF who has worked as an Industrial Engineering Intern at Lockheed Martin for about seven months. When he started, he expected work writing to be like the lab reports he wrote in school. Instead, he found himself writing emails, Teams messages, status reports, and work instructions for technicians, quality engineers, and managers, who all need different things. Looking back on what changed for him, he said, "At school I wrote to show the professor I understood the material. At work nobody cares what I know." In school, Ethan learned only one version of good writing: long, detailed writing that proves to one reader, the professor, that you understand the topic. Chimamanda Adichie warns about "the danger of a single story," where seeing only one version of something gives an incomplete picture of it (Adichie). Ethan's school experience gave him a single story of what good writing is. At Lockheed Martin, that single story did not hold up. A work instruction is good if a technician can follow it on the floor, and a status report is good if his manager can make a decision from it quickly. Because Ethan now writes for many readers, he has many definitions of "good" writing instead of one.

Ethan's idea of good writing also changed because of a mistake that had real results on the production floor. Early in his first semester, he sent a Friday email to the material handlers saying kits would move to a new staging area "starting next week." He meant the following

Monday, but they read it as that same week. The parts were moved two days early, a kitting cart ended up in the wrong spot, and a build shift lost about an hour looking for it. Ethan explained what he does differently now: "Now I always write exact dates and say who does what, like, On Monday November tenth at six a.m. material handling moves kits A through D to Station Four. No room for confusion." Before this mistake, a phrase like "next week" seemed clear enough to Ethan. After it, his standard for good writing became exact dates, times, and names. This shows that the definition of good writing is not something a writer learns once. It keeps changing as the writer sees how real readers act on the words.

Writers take up agency when they feel they have enough evidence and trust to back up their choices. Ethan said that as an intern, he does not have full agency. For example, he cannot change a work instruction alone, because every change needs review and sign-off from several people. But he does use agency in other places, such as the time study tracker he built from scratch with no template, which his team now uses in their morning meetings. When I asked whether he feels he can question how things are written or done, he told a story from his first month. At a kaizen event, he noticed a senior engineer's slide had a cycle time number that looked wrong, but he stayed quiet because he was new and unsure. Afterward, he checked his data, told his manager privately, and she told him he could ask it as a question in the room next time. He summed up what he learned: "Being an intern doesn't mean you have no voice. It means you'd better bring data with it." This shows that Ethan did not take up agency at first because he was new and did not yet trust his place on the team. Once he checked his numbers and his manager gave him permission, he started speaking up. For Ethan, agency is not given automatically by a job title. It grows when a writer has proof to support their choices and people around them who are willing to listen.

## Works Cited

Adichie, Chimamanda Ngozi. "The Danger of a Single Story." *TED*, July 2009, www.ted.com/talks/chimamanda_ngozi_adichie_the_danger_of_a_single_story.

Wong, Ethan. Personal interview. Conducted by Michael Wong, 2026.

## Technology Statement

I used these tools to complete this part of my project:

- **Webcourses:** I watched Chimamanda Adichie's TED Talk, "The Danger of a Single Story," through our course page.
- **Apple MacBook:** I did all of my writing and project work on my laptop.
- **Phone:** I recorded the interview with Ethan and made the transcript.
- **Pen and paper:** I took handwritten notes during the interview.
- **Microsoft Word:** I typed and formatted my writing.